Product Requirements Document

Multi-Lender Student Financing Marketplace

Status: MVP built and tested Owner: Arnav Version: 1.0

1. Problem Statement

Students seeking education financing must currently approach lenders one at a time, with no way to compare eligibility or terms upfront. This creates two problems: students waste time applying to lenders they don't qualify for, and they have no way to know whether they're getting a competitive rate before committing.

2. Goal

Let a student enter their financial profile once and immediately see every partner lender they're eligible for, ranked by estimated cost, with a clear reason given for any lender they don't qualify for.

3. Personas

Primary: The Applying Student. Needs to borrow between Rs. 50K and Rs. 25L for tuition, often has thin or developing credit, and doesn't know which lenders will even consider their application.

Secondary: The Partner Lender. Wants qualified leads only — applicants who already meet their underwriting criteria, reducing wasted review effort on their side.

4. User Stories

- As a student, I want to enter my loan amount, credit standing, and desired tenure once, so that I don't have to repeat this for every lender.
- As a student, I want to see which lenders I'm eligible for and which I'm not, with a clear reason for rejection, so I don't waste time on a dead-end application.
- As a student with thin credit, I want to know if adding a co-signer would unlock additional lenders, so I can make an informed decision before applying.
- As a student, I want offers ranked by estimated interest rate, so the best available option is obvious without manual comparison.
- As a product owner, I want every step of this journey logged as an event, so we can see where applicants drop off and improve the funnel.

5. Functional Requirements

1. The system shall accept an applicant's requested loan amount, credit tier, requested tenure, and co-signer availability.
2. The system shall evaluate the applicant against all active partner lenders' underwriting rules (minimum credit tier, loan amount range, maximum tenure, co-signer conditions).
3. The system shall return a ranked list of eligible offers, sorted by estimated interest rate (ascending), and a separate list of ineligible partners with a specific, human-readable rejection reason for each.
4. The system shall log an analytics event at each of the four funnel stages: eligibility checked, offers viewed, partner selected, application initiated.
5. The system shall expose a funnel summary endpoint returning real, queried conversion counts at each stage.

6. Partner Rules Modelled (MVP scope: 4 partners)

Partner	Min. Credit	Amount Range	Max Tenure	Rate Range
EduFund Direct	Fair	Rs. 50K – Rs. 15L	7 yrs	10.5–13.5%
ScholarBridge Finance	Good	Rs. 1L – Rs. 20L	10 yrs	8.75–11.0%
CampusCredit Co-op	Thin File*	Rs. 50K – Rs. 8L	5 yrs	12.0–15.0%
NextGen Education Loans	Good	Rs. 2L – Rs. 25L	15 yrs	7.5–10.0%

*Thin File accepted only with a co-signer.

7. Success Metrics (KPIs)

- **Eligibility-to-offers-viewed rate** — did the applicant see any real offers, or hit a dead end?
- **Offers-viewed-to-partner-selected rate** — of those with eligible offers, how many engaged further?
- **Partner-selected-to-application-initiated rate** — the hardest conversion: intent to action.
- **Co-signer unlock rate** — how often a co-signer prompt converts an otherwise-ineligible applicant.

8. MVP Scope

In scope: 4 simulated partners with distinct, realistic underwriting rules; real-time eligibility and rate-ranking logic; full funnel event instrumentation; a queryable funnel analytics endpoint.

Out of scope for MVP: real partner API integrations, actual credit bureau pulls, document upload and verification, loan servicing post-approval.

9. Roadmap (Post-MVP)

1. Replace simulated partner rules with real partner API contracts.
2. Add a soft credit-check integration to replace self-reported credit tier.
3. A/B test the co-signer prompt's placement and wording to improve the unlock rate.
4. Add segment-level funnel breakdowns (by credit tier, requested amount band) to the analytics endpoint.